INTERNAL PRODUCT & STRATEGY BRIEF

InvestIQ

Building businesses that are ready for serious capital.

FDN Capital Partners

Draft for Internal Alignment | October 2026

PRIVATE & CONFIDENTIAL

01 | EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

What InvestIQ Is

InvestIQ is FDN Capital Partners' investment-readiness system for determining how investable a business is, identifying what could prevent it from raising capital, and helping management fix those gaps before approaching investors.

InvestIQ is designed to go beyond pitch-deck preparation. Its purpose is to assess the underlying quality, readiness and credibility of a business from an investor's perspective, then provide a structured pathway for improvement.

The central question

If an investor looked at this business today, what would make them invest, what would make them hesitate, and what would make them walk away?

Why it matters

- Too many businesses approach investors before the business itself is ready for institutional scrutiny.
- Readiness gaps often sit beneath the pitch deck: governance, financial reporting, ownership, team, capital structure, valuation, diligence and commercial quality.
- InvestIQ gives FDN a repeatable framework for diagnosing those issues before the market does.
- Over time, the methodology can become proprietary intellectual property that supports advisory work, institutional partnerships and CapitalQ.

CORE PRINCIPLE
Do not prepare a company to pitch. Prepare the company to withstand investor scrutiny.

02 | STRATEGIC RATIONALE

The Problem InvestIQ Solves

A business can have a strong idea, credible founders, real customers and an attractive market, yet still be uninvestable at the point it enters the market for capital. Investors evaluate the entire enterprise, not only the story presented in a deck.

Common investment blockers

AREA	WHAT CAN BREAK THE INVESTMENT CASE
Governance	Weak decision-making structures, unclear shareholder rights, missing board discipline or poor reporting.
Financial readiness	Unreliable historical accounts, weak forecasting, poor cash-flow visibility or unsupported assumptions.
Corporate structure	Cap-table complexity, legal gaps, licensing issues, unresolved ownership or documentation.
Commercial quality	Weak customer concentration, unclear unit economics, fragile distribution or insufficient evidence of demand.
Management depth	Founder dependency, missing critical hires, unclear roles or execution gaps.
Capital strategy	Wrong capital instrument, poorly structured raise, weak use of funds or unrealistic valuation.
Diligence readiness	Incomplete data room, inconsistent information, missing evidence or slow management responses.

InvestIQ's role inside FDN

InvestIQ should function as the diagnostic and improvement layer within FDN's broader capital journey. It establishes whether a business is genuinely ready for capital, what needs to change, and what form of capital is most appropriate before investor outreach begins.

Assess → Prepare → Position → Connect → Execute

01 **ASSESS** Understand the business as an investor would.

- Business model and market
- Traction and commercial evidence
- Financial performance and forecasts
- Team and governance
- Legal and corporate structure
- Capital requirements and investor fit

02 **PREPARE** Fix the gaps that could stop the investment.

- Financial model and reporting
- Governance and ownership clean-up
- Critical management gaps
- Data room and diligence readiness
- Commercial and operating improvements

03 **POSITION** Translate the business into a credible investment proposition.

- Investment narrative
- Capital strategy and raise structure
- Valuation framing
- Use of funds
- Investor materials and positioning

04 **CONNECT** Target the right type of capital once the business is ready.

- Investor segmentation
- Mandate alignment
- Equity vs debt vs strategic capital
- FDN relationships, origination channels and CapitalQ

05 **EXECUTE** Support the transaction through diligence and closing.

- Investor engagement
- Diligence coordination
- Negotiation support
- Capital-structure discussions
- Transaction management

04 | ASSESSMENT FRAMEWORK

What InvestIQ Should Assess

1. Business Fundamentals	Business model, revenue model, competitive advantage, market size, scalability.
2. Commercial Strength	Traction, revenue quality, customer base, retention, distribution, sales engine, partnerships.
3. Financial Readiness	Historical financials, forecasts, cash flow, profitability, working capital, capital efficiency, debt.
4. Governance	Board, decision-making, reporting, ownership, shareholder structure, controls.
5. Management & Team	Founder quality, leadership depth, succession, organisational structure, critical hires.
6. Legal & Corporate	Incorporation, licences, contracts, shareholder agreements, IP, regulatory exposure.
7. Investment Case	Raise amount, use of funds, valuation, dilution, investment structure, exit logic, return potential.
8. Investor Fit	Equity vs debt, venture vs growth capital, family office vs institution, strategic vs financial investor.
9. Diligence Readiness	Data room, financial records, legal documents, management reporting, cap table, commercial evidence.

Valuation as a module

Valuation should sit inside InvestIQ as one component of the investment case, not as a standalone substitute for readiness. FDN's valuation work should triangulate appropriate methods based on lifecycle stage and available evidence, including comparable companies, precedent transactions, revenue or EBITDA multiples, DCF where visibility supports it, peer-relative analysis, dilution math and negotiated fundraising pricing.

What an InvestIQ Engagement Should Produce

- Investment-readiness assessment
- InvestIQ score or readiness profile once the scoring methodology is formally approved
- Key strengths and investment blockers
- Evidence gaps and diligence risks
- Recommended improvement priorities
- Capital requirements and capital-structure recommendations
- Investor-fit profile
- Valuation and dilution observations where appropriate
- Readiness roadmap and next-step recommendations

Who it is for

USER	PRIMARY USE
Early-stage startups	Preparing for institutional seed or Series A and needing to understand whether the company is genuinely ready.
Established SMEs	Operational businesses that may be profitable but have never raised professional external capital.
Growth-stage businesses	Companies considering growth equity, private equity, structured capital, debt or strategic investment.
First-time fundraisers	Management teams that need a clear view of investor expectations before entering the market.
Institutions	Accelerators, banks, DFIs, family offices and investment platforms that need a structured way to improve or screen business readiness.

InvestIQ Inside the FDN Ecosystem

FDN CAPITAL PARTNERS
The firm: capital, intelligence, relationships, strategic markets and transaction execution.

INVESTIQ
The investability methodology: assess readiness, identify gaps, improve the business and determine appropriate capital.

CAPITALQ
The technology and investment-intelligence infrastructure: discovery, matching, qualification, investor workflow and structured opportunity intelligence.

AFRICA → ARABIA
The strategic-market and distribution corridor connecting African businesses with capital, institutions and markets across the GCC.

InvestIQ vs. CapitalQ

	INVESTIQ	CAPITALQ
Core question	How investable is this company, and what needs to change?	Which businesses fit which investors, and how can both sides understand each other faster?
Primary role	Assessment, preparation, readiness and capital strategy.	Discovery, matching, qualification and investment intelligence.
Human / tech balance	Methodology-led, potentially software-enabled.	Technology-led, supported by structured data and human judgment.
Relationship	InvestIQ improves the quality of businesses entering the capital market.	CapitalQ improves how investors discover and process opportunities.

How InvestIQ Can Create Value

InvestIQ can serve as an entry point into FDN's wider capital journey, with diagnostic work leading into readiness improvement, capital strategy, transaction preparation and, where appropriate, fundraising execution.

Commercial architecture under consideration

- Initial diagnostic / InvestIQ assessment
- Readiness sprint or improvement engagement
- Capital strategy and transaction preparation
- Fundraising or capital execution mandate
- Potential institutional licensing or cohort-based delivery over time

Critical guardrails

- Paying for InvestIQ must never guarantee investor access, investment approval or fundraising success.
- Assessment and investor selection should remain independent enough to protect credibility.
- A business may be advised not to raise equity if debt, strategic capital, internal restructuring or delayed fundraising is more appropriate.
- Scores should never create false precision. Evidence quality and investment judgment must remain visible.
- Different company stages and capital instruments may require different readiness models.

What Is Defined vs. What Still Needs to Be Finalised

DEFINED / WORKING PRINCIPLE	TO BE FINALISED
• InvestIQ is FDN's investment-readiness system.	• Final scoring formula and category weightings.
• It assesses the business, not only the pitch deck.	• Score bands, thresholds and evidence standards.
• The journey is Assess → Prepare → Position → Connect → Execute.	• Stage-specific and instrument-specific assessment models.
• Investor fit and capital strategy are part of readiness.	• Standard founder / management questionnaire.
• CapitalQ and InvestIQ are complementary, not interchangeable.	• Final report template and dashboard.
• Investor access is not guaranteed by paying for readiness work.	• Pricing, packaging and delivery timelines.
	• Rules for investor-facing visibility of any InvestIQ score.
	• Extent of future integration into CapitalQ.

Recommended next internal workstream

1. Lock the assessment dimensions and evidence requirements.
2. Design the scoring logic without creating false precision.
3. Create a standard management questionnaire and document checklist.
4. Design the InvestIQ report and improvement roadmap.
5. Pilot the methodology on 3-5 existing FDN businesses across different stages.
6. Refine the framework from real investment outcomes and investor feedback.
7. Decide what should remain human judgment and what can eventually be productised in CapitalQ.

The Strategic Opportunity

Investor access is valuable, but it is not highly defensible on its own. FDN's long-term advantage can become its ability to determine whether a business is genuinely ready for capital, improve that business against institutional standards, and generate better-quality opportunities for investors.

InvestIQ can evolve from a consulting methodology into a standardised assessment, then into software-enabled infrastructure used by businesses, accelerators, banks, DFIs, family offices and investment platforms.

Working one-sentence definition

InvestIQ is FDN Capital Partners' investment-readiness system for assessing how investable a business is, identifying what could prevent it from raising capital, and helping management fix those gaps before approaching investors.

Commercial expression

Before you raise capital, know what investors will see.

InvestIQ assesses the business, identifies the gaps standing between it and investment, and helps management become ready for the right capital.

BETTER BUSINESSES. BETTER INVESTMENTS. STRONGER CAPITAL MARKETS.